

Chapter 123-1

Liang Shi protected Xu Qingzhu very well, cushioning the back of her head with her hand, so that even when her back landed on the car seat, she didn't feel much impact.

It was just that the two of them were too close together.

The light inside the car was very dim, with only faint streetlight rays filtering in from outside, and Liang Shi was backlit.

Even though Xu Qingzhu had good eyesight, she still found it somewhat difficult to see clearly.

But she could see those pupils clearly.

In the dimness, the only thing reflected in those eyes was her own face.

She had clearly just said something threatening with an aggressive air, yet there wasn't a hint of threatening demeanor at all—instead, it made one find her amusing.

Those eyes held warmth, heat, and an intoxicating beauty.

The taste of alcohol seemed to still linger on Xu Qingzhu's lips and tongue. The drink was refreshing and sweet when it first entered the mouth, carrying a slight coolness, but as it flowed down the throat it became warm, burning the heart and lungs along with it.

One could tell without thinking that the aftertaste would be strong.

Xu Qingzhu had average alcohol tolerance and wasn't someone who drank much to begin with. She couldn't resist the alcohol's aftertaste at all, and her mind was now somewhat hazy.

She hadn't actually drunk much, but she had been made tipsy and slightly drunk by the alcoholic atmosphere in this cramped space.

"Then who should I like?" Xu Qingzhu's voice lilted upward at the end as she spoke, as if tinged with rich intoxication, her brows and eyes carrying smiles.

That face that seamlessly combined purity and allure was at this moment both innocent and enticing.

That cool, clear voice seemed coated with honey—sticky yet making one's heart tingle with a numb, itchy feeling.

Liang Shi paused, slightly dazed.

A few seconds later, Liang Shi leaned down and bit the side of her face, then bit the corner of her lips.

Purely, without a trace of amorous intent.

Xu Qingzhu's finger poked at her waist, then lightly pinched her.

Liang Shi said, "Anyway..."

She paused for a moment, "You can't like her."

Xu Qingzhu asked, "Why?"

Liang Shi pressed her lips together, her brows and eyes lowered, her long eyelashes fluttering a few times, casting shadows beneath her eyelids.

After a moment of silence in the cramped space, Liang Shi finally lifted her up and tightened the collar of her suit, the pads of her fingers still retaining the coolness from her skin.

Liang Shi's voice sounded, "I don't like Qi Jiao."

These words carried a hint of petulance, "So of course you can't like her either."

Xu Qingzhu: "?"

Liang Shi was drunk.

Her words were unclear.

Her head rested on Xu Qingzhu's shoulder, her voice murmuring, "You can like..."

Her voice trailed off here.

Xu Qingzhu looked down and found that she had closed her eyes and fallen asleep.

The most important part that followed was left unsaid.

The alcohol's aftertaste was strong enough to make one fall asleep quickly. It could also be that Liang Shi hadn't been resting well recently, had experienced many things during the day, was mentally exhausted by evening, and had relaxed after drinking a few glasses of wine, so she fell asleep very quickly.

Meanwhile, Xu Qingzhu was only slightly tipsy.

She lowered her brows and eyes to look at Liang Shi, who had peacefully fallen asleep. Her slender, fair fingers landed on her jawline and gently traced along it.

Xu Qingzhu's voice was muffled, "What a dummy, jiejie~"¹

Footnotes:

¹ **Jiejie (姐姐):** Meaning "older sister" in Chinese. This is a significant term in this story, as it refers to the childhood bond between Xu Qingzhu and Liang Shi when they were both kidnapped as children. Xu Qingzhu called young Liang Shi "jiejie" back then, and this term carries deep emotional weight representing their shared traumatic past and the protective role Liang Shi played.